



Rich Internet Applications (RIA) are created by manipulating the Document Object Model (DOM) elements in various ways. Before working on DOM elements we need to have an efficient and easy way to identify and select the elements required. The JQuery library provides different options to identify an element. The power of JQuery is that it allows us, users of the library, to write our own selectors.

All selectors will start with a `$` symbol and the selector string is placed within `()`. Note that `$` is just a short form of JQuery. All selectors will return an array of elements that satisfy the condition. An element in the array can be indexed as a JavaScript array or by using `"get"`, the JQuery utility method. For example, to get the first DOM element in the page, we can use both `$("#")[0]` and `$("#").get(0)`.

Basic selectors

The most efficient way of selecting an element is by using the ID of that element. JQuery, in turn, uses the native method, `getElementById()`. For example, to get an element with the ID `msg`, the selector should be `$("#msg")`.

An element can be selected using its type. To select the entire `span` element in a page, we can use `$("span")`. For an appealing

look and feel for an element, it should be associated with a class. JQuery provides ways to select elements based on this class. For example, when we need to associate a click operation with all the elements that have a class `.button`, then...

```
$('.button').click(function(){
    console.log('Element with class button is
clicked');
});
```

`$(*)` is used to select all the DOM elements in a page.

We can combine different selectors together using the comma. The resulting array will contain all the elements that satisfy any of the condition(s) passed. For the following selector query:

```
$("#msgdiv , .msgdiv")
```